

challenge, prompting us to restore balance through solar-powered water systems, community participation, and technology-enabled protection.

If there is one insight that has consistently guided my work, it is this: **the most enduring solutions are those that create ownership rather than dependency.** Whether in business or philanthropy, real value is created when people are empowered to become architects of their own future.

To me, **innovation** is not about inventing something the world has never seen. It is about seeing what the world has overlooked—and having the conviction to build institutions that transform that insight into lasting societal change.

Recognition is always encouraging, but I believe it should be viewed as a responsibility rather than a destination. Being recognised as the **No. 1 philanthropic organisation in India's real estate sector**, leading Gurugram's giving with a **₹70 crore social investment**, is deeply humbling because it reflects not just the scale of our contribution, but the scale of our commitment. What makes me particularly proud is that this recognition acknowledges an approach to philanthropy that is both strategic and sustainable. This achievement is also a testament to the visionary leadership of my father **Shri Basant Bansal Ji** and **Shri Roop Bansal Ji**, whose unwavering belief that business success must be accompanied by social responsibility has shaped the Foundation's purpose and direction. I consider it a privilege to carry that vision forward alongside an incredibly committed team.

Ultimately, philanthropy should never be measured only by the quantum of giving, but by the quality of change it creates. If our work has strengthened a child's future, empowered a woman to earn with dignity, restored an ecosystem, or enabled a community to become self-reliant, then we have created value that no ranking can truly quantify. Awards acknowledge the journey, but the real reward is witnessing lives transformed and communities empowered to shape their own future.

Who are you beyond the net worth figure? What do you read, how do you make decisions, and what did you almost give up on?

I have always found it rather limiting when people attempt to define an individual by a balance sheet. My net worth is not mine alone; it represents the entrepreneurial journey, values, and legacy of my family built over decades. But personal worth is measured very differently. It is reflected in one's character, convictions, and ultimately, in the difference one makes to the lives of others.

Beyond business and philanthropy, I am an eternal student. I enjoy reading history, biographies of transformational leaders, philosophy, spirituality, behavioural psychology, and increasingly, literature on climate science and sustainable development. I find myself drawn to books that explore not merely how successful people built institutions, but why they chose to build them. Ideas have always fascinated me far more than accolades because ideas have the power to outlive individuals. When it comes to decision-making, **I have learnt to balance intellect with intuition.** Data provides direction, but values provide judgement. Every important decision I make is filtered through three simple questions: **Is it ethical? Will it create long-term value? And will it leave people and**

communities better than I found them? If the answer to all three is yes, the decision becomes remarkably clear.

People often ask whether there was ever a moment I almost gave up. The answer is yes—not on my purpose, but occasionally on my own patience. Social transformation is slow. You seldom witness change overnight. There are days when progress feels invisible and challenges seem relentless. But working closely with communities has taught me that meaningful change operates on the timescale of trust, not headlines. A tree does not become a forest in a season, and a child does not become empowered in a day. Lasting transformation demands consistency, compassion, and the courage to persist long after the applause has faded.

If there is one belief that anchors my life, it is this: **privilege is not a destination; it is a responsibility.** I have been fortunate to inherit opportunity, but I also believe that the true measure of that privilege lies in how many opportunities I can create for others. Wealth may build enterprises, but purpose builds legacies. And if, years from now, I am remembered not for what I possessed, but for what I enabled—for women who became financially independent, children who found access to education, communities that became *Aatmanirbhar*, and ecosystems that were restored—then I would consider that the most meaningful measure of success.

